AgePass

Prove you're 18+. Not who you are.

Zero-knowledge age checks on Midnight

Emediong Etuk Gregory · Midnight Network Buildathon · Wave 1

The problem: age checks leak identities

- UK, EU, Australia and many US states now push platforms to **verify age**: social, gaming, dating, alcohol, betting.
- Today that means **uploading a passport or a face scan to every site**.
- Sites only need *yes or no*, but end up **holding full identities**: breached, sold, kept forever.
- Users drop off at the ID upload. Merchants carry liability they never wanted.

The solution in one sentence

Verify once with a trusted issuer, then prove "18+" anywhere with a zero-knowledge proof: the site learns yes, plus a nickname that only works on that site.

How it works

1. **Verify once.** The issuer checks your ID off-chain and adds a hidden commitment to a Merkle tree on Midnight. Birth date never goes on-chain.
2. **Prove anywhere.** A site asks “18+?”. Your device proves: I hold *some* issued credential, it hasn’t expired, and my birth date ≤ the cutoff.
3. **Site learns “yes”.** Public record: site, the dates asked, and `nym = H(secret, site)`. Same site ⇒ same nym. Different sites ⇒ unlinkable.

Privacy by design: what's public, what isn't

Data	On-chain?
Name, ID document	Never collected
Birth date, expiry, holder secret, holder key	**Never** (private inputs only)
Which credential you used	**Never** (Merkle membership hides the leaf)
Approved issuers, credential count	Public (accountability)
challengeId, siteId, **nym**, cutoffDate, checkedOn	Public (the site's "yes")

Tested: the spec suite and the local demo scan the raw public state for every private value.

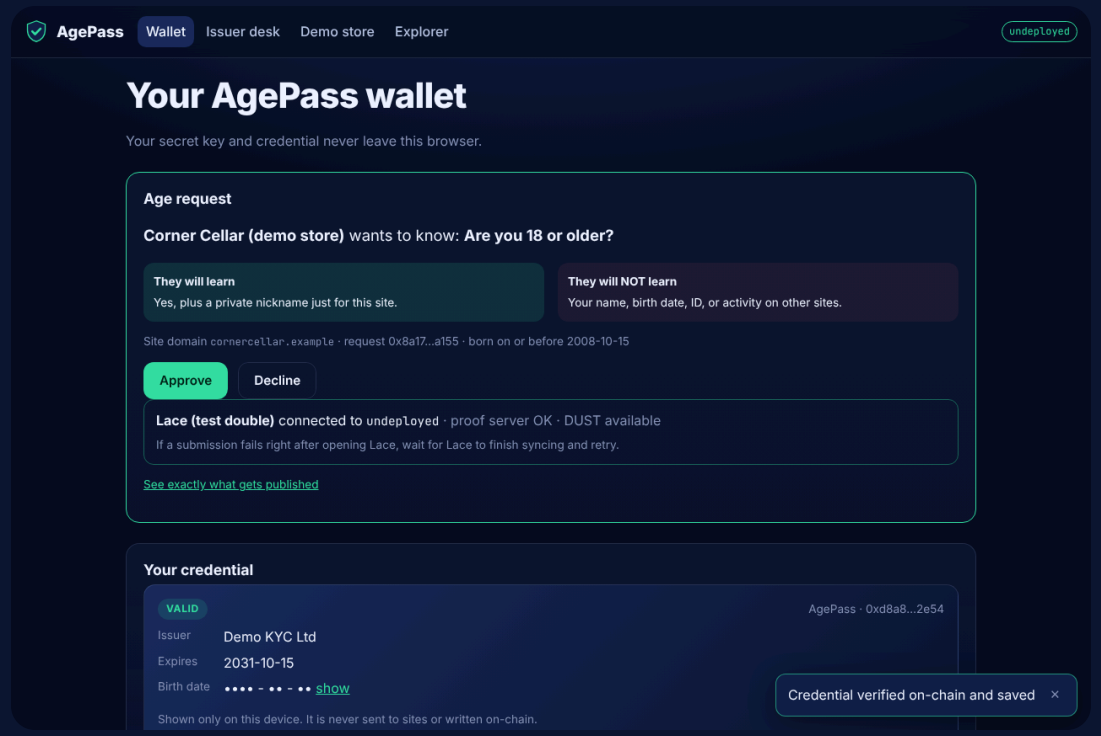
Why Midnight makes this possible

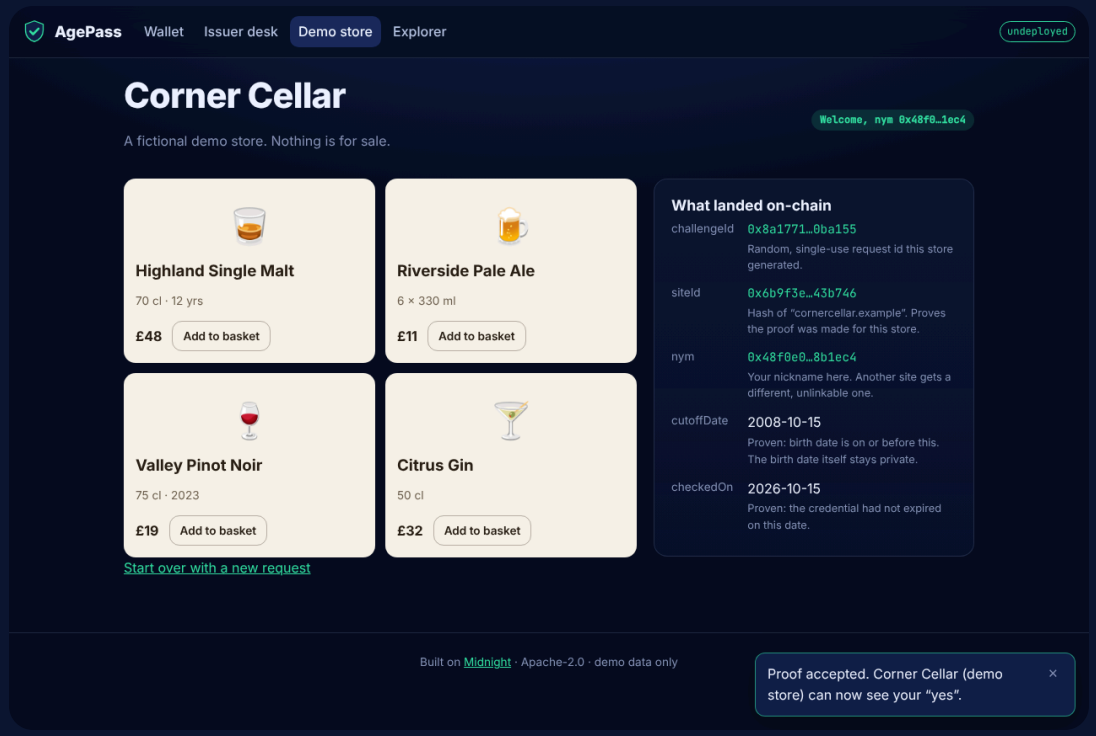
- **Dual ledger**: public `issuers`, `credentials`, `verifications` beside private keys and credentials that live only on the device.
- `disclose()` **boundaries** enforced by the compiler: every public value is explicit and commented.
- **ZK membership with** `HistoricMerkleTree`: proofs hide *which* credential and survive new issuances.
- **Exported pure circuits**: TypeScript reuses the contract's exact hashes.
- **Shielded DUST fees** and a **local proof server**: witness data never leaves the machine.

Architecture



Demo





Approve → proof in ~30 s → store unlocks with a nym. A 16-year-old is stopped on-device: nothing sent.

Testing and reliability

Suite	Result
Contract spec tests (simulator, no Docker)	**33/33**
SDK tests (99% line coverage of helpers)	**67/67**
`e2e:local` on a real local Midnight node	**all checks pass**, 6 transactions
Every CLI command against the devnet	**pass**
Browser E2E: issue + prove from Chromium on a local node	**pass**
CI on every push: compile (Compact 0.31.1), lint, licence, tests, app build	GitHub Actions

Market and business model

- **Who pays:** age-gated platforms and regulated merchants, **per verification**; cheaper than document checks, with no PII to secure.
- **Who earns:** issuers (banks, telcos, KYC providers) **per issuance**: new revenue from KYC they already did.
- **Users:** free.
- **GTM:** one issuer + one platform pilot → drop-in widget → issuer network.
- **Beyond age:** residency, student status, verified human.

Roadmap

Wave	Scope
1 (now)	Contract, SDK, CLI, web app, local + Preview demo, tests, docs
2	“Verify with AgePass” JS widget · encrypted backup/restore · real revocation · fee sponsorship
3	More predicates (residency, student, human) · multiple issuers · pilot partner · device binding

The ask

Try it: `npm ci && npm run compact && npm test`, then `npm run demo:local`

Looking for **an issuer** and **an age-gated platform** to pilot with.

github.com/Emediong-Etuk/AgePass · Built on Midnight · Apache-2.0

Live on Midnight Preview: `54fc78d8890099e2…221069d2`